SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #14 · HOLY SPIRIT

“The Spirit’s leading always comes as a strong feeling.”

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Where it often comes from

Hearing people say “God told me” or “I felt led” about every choice. A church that put more weight on impressions than on Scripture and wise counsel. Waiting for a feeling before making decisions, and freezing when it never came. Mistaking anxiety, excitement, or fear for God’s voice. Times when a strong feeling led you in a bad direction.

What Scripture teaches

God guides His people, but not always through strong feelings. Elijah found that the LORD was not in the wind, the earthquake, or the fire, but came in a still, small voice. The Spirit leads through Scripture, a renewed mind, wise counsel, circumstances, and sometimes quiet impressions. Feelings can be helpful, but they must be tested. God gives wisdom generously to those who ask.

> *“Then the LORD said, ‘Go out and stand on the mountain before the LORD. Behold, the LORD is about to pass by.’ And a great and mighty wind tore into the mountains and shattered the rocks before the LORD, but the LORD was not in the wind. After the wind there was an earthquake, but the LORD was not in the earthquake. After the earthquake there was a fire, but the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire came a still, small voice”* **(1 Kings 19:11–12)**.

Also see

> “Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God” **(Romans 12:2)**.

> “Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight” **(Proverbs 3:5–6)**.

> “Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him” **(James 1:5)**.

> “Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God. For many false prophets have gone out into the world” **(1 John 4:1)**.

Common self-statements

- I can’t decide until I feel sure.
- If I don’t feel it, God isn’t leading me.
- That strong feeling must be from God.
- I must have missed God because I felt nothing.
- Other people hear from God; I don’t.
- My anxiety must be the Spirit warning me.

Common logical errors

- **Emotional reasoning:** Treating a strong feeling as automatic proof of God’s will.
- **Mind reading:** Assuming you know God is silent because you do not feel Him.

- **Overgeneralization:** Turning “God sometimes guides through impressions” into “He always does.”
- **Discounting the positive:** Overlooking Scripture, wisdom, and counsel as real ways God leads.
- **Should statements:** “I should feel a clear sign before every choice.”

Challenging questions

- Where was the LORD in Elijah’s story: the fire or the still, small voice?
- What does Scripture already say about this choice?
- Have strong feelings ever led me wrong before?
- Could this feeling be anxiety, excitement, or fear rather than the Spirit?
- Have I asked God for wisdom and sought wise counsel?
- Does the Bible tell me to test what I feel?
- If I make a wise choice in faith, will God abandon me?

Truth summary

> The Holy Spirit leads me, but not only through strong feelings. He guides through His Word, a renewed mind, wise counsel, and quiet nudges. I can test my feelings instead of obeying them blindly. When I ask God for wisdom, He gives it generously, and I can move forward in faith.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Guidance
- Will of God
- Wisdom
- Holy Spirit
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "The Spirit's leading always comes as a strong feeling"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The Spirit's leading always comes as a strong feeling." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Was the LORD in the fire or the still, small voice?
- ☐ What does Scripture already say about this?
- ☐ Have strong feelings ever led me wrong?
- ☐ Could this be anxiety rather than the Spirit?
- ☐ Have I asked for wisdom and wise counsel?
- ☐ Am I testing this feeling, or just obeying it?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God often leads in a still, small voice.
- ☐ The Spirit guides through His Word and a renewed mind.
- ☐ I can test my feelings by Scripture.
- ☐ God gives wisdom generously when I ask.
- ☐ I can make a wise choice in faith without a strong feeling.
- ☐ God will make my paths straight as I trust Him.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Kings 19:11–12**
  "Then the LORD said, 'Go out and stand on the mountain before the LORD. Behold, the LORD is about to pass by.' And a great and mighty wind tore into the mountains and shattered the rocks before the LORD, but the LORD was not in the wind. After the wind there was an earthquake, but the LORD was not in the earthquake. After the earthquake there was a fire, but the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire came a still, small voice."

- [ ] **Romans 12:2**
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

- [ ] **Proverbs 3:5–6**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."

- [ ] **James 1:5**
  "Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him."

- [ ] **1 John 4:1**
  "Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God. For many false prophets have gone out into the world."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Guidance log:** For each decision this week, write what Scripture, wise counsel, and common sense say, alongside what I feel.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, James 1:5 becomes: "Now if **Sarah** lacks wisdom, **she** should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to **her**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Guidance" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Make one small decision this week** using Scripture, prayer, and common sense, without waiting for a strong feeling. Note the result.
- ☐ **Write down a strong feeling about a choice,** then wait 24 hours and pray before acting. See if the feeling holds.
- ☐ **Ask two wise Christians for counsel** on a current decision, and compare their advice with your feelings.
- ☐ **Read 1 Kings 19:1–18 slowly,** and write how God met Elijah when he was exhausted and afraid.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The Spirit's leading always comes as a strong feeling": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One choice I made in faith
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The Spirit's leading always comes as a strong feeling.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Holy Spirit, thank You that You lead me, even when I do not feel You. Help me reject the lie that Your leading always comes as a strong feeling. Teach me to listen for Your still, small voice, to test what I feel by Your Word, and to move forward in faith. I ask You for wisdom today. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.